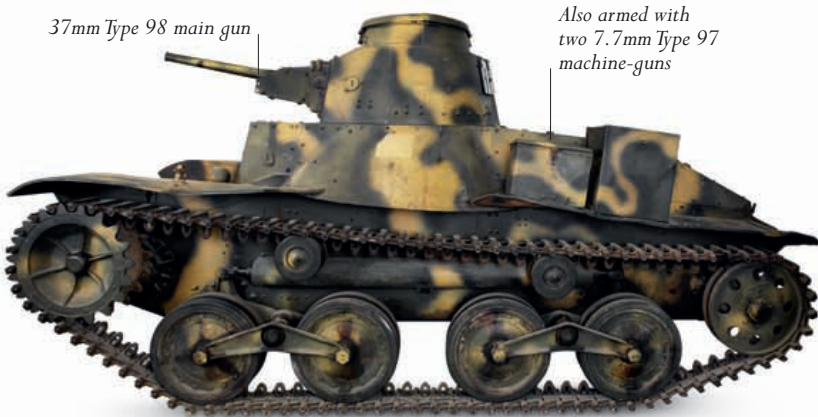


# AXIS ARMoured FIGHTING VEHICLES

As the nation that developed the concept of *Blitzkrieg*, it was hardly surprising that Germany should develop some of the most advanced and effective armoured fighting vehicles (AFVs) of World War II. The Panther and Tiger tanks struck fear in their Allied opponents, but, unlike the Allies, German tank manufacturers could not utilize the methods of mass production, as their vehicles were slow and expensive to build. Germany's Axis partners, Italy and Japan, produced some effective designs in the 1930s, but were unable to develop them further as the war progressed.



▲ TYPE 95 HA-GO LIGHT TANK

|           |                                                           |        |       |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------|-------|
| Date      | 1936                                                      | Origin | Japan |
| Weight    | 7.4 tonnes (8.1 tons)                                     |        |       |
| Length    | 4.38m (14½ft)                                             |        |       |
| Top speed | 45kph (28mph)                                             |        |       |
| Engine    | Mitsubishi NVD 6120 6-cylinder 89kW (120hp) diesel engine |        |       |

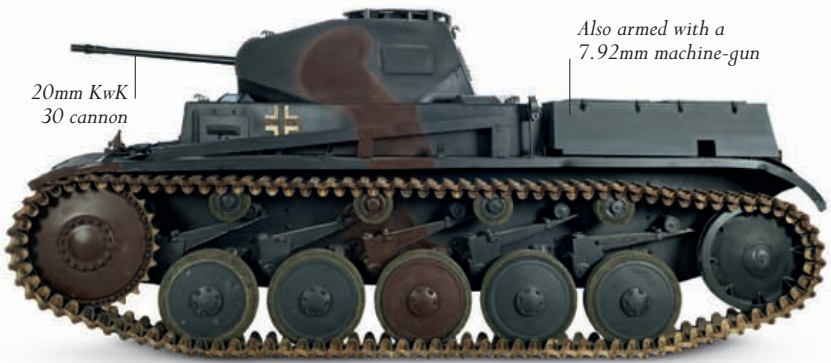
Entering service in the 1930s, this three-man tank was typical of its time. While it proved successful during the war in China, it was outclassed by US armour and anti-tank guns during World War II.



▲ PANZERKAMPFWAGEN IV MEDIUM TANK

|           |                                                           |        |         |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------|---------|
| Date      | 1936                                                      | Origin | Germany |
| Weight    | 25 tonnes (27.5 tons)                                     |        |         |
| Length    | 5.89m (19¼ft)                                             |        |         |
| Top speed | 38kph (24mph)                                             |        |         |
| Engine    | Maybach HL 120TRM 12-cylinder 224kW (300hp) petrol engine |        |         |

Intended to adopt the role of an infantry support vehicle, the Panzer IV developed into a potent main battle tank as a result of a series of upgrades that improved protection and firepower. With a crew of five, the Panzer IV was the only German tank to remain in service throughout the war.



▲ PANZERKAMPFWAGEN II LIGHT TANK, AUSF F

|           |                                                |        |         |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------|--------|---------|
| Date      | 1935                                           | Origin | Germany |
| Weight    | 10 tonnes (11 tons)                            |        |         |
| Length    | 4.64m (15¼ft)                                  |        |         |
| Top speed | 55kph (34mph)                                  |        |         |
| Engine    | Maybach 6-cylinder 104kW (140hp) petrol engine |        |         |

The Panzer II, manned by a crew of three, was originally created to function as a training tank. However, the shortage of more powerful models brought it into the front line, where it was used in huge numbers for the invasions of Poland and France.

► CARRO VELOCE L3-33 FLAMETHROWER

|           |                                   |        |       |
|-----------|-----------------------------------|--------|-------|
| Date      | 1936                              | Origin | Italy |
| Weight    | 3.2 tonnes (3.5 tons)             |        |       |
| Length    | 3.17m (10½ft)                     |        |       |
| Top speed | 42kph (26mph)                     |        |       |
| Engine    | SPA CV3 32kW (43hp) petrol engine |        |       |

Developed from the British Carden-Lloyd tankette, this modified version of the L3-35 replaced its twin machine-guns with a flamethrower nozzle. The flame fuel was carried in a 500-litre (132-gallon) trailer towed by the vehicle.

